The most unexpected demonstration took place yesterday evening in one of the oldest settlements, Gush Etzion: right-wingers, many of them belonging to the Religious Zionist Party, came out against the judicial reform. They do not deny the need for some changes, but they see the danger in attempting to ram a radical reform down the throats of most of the population. They demonstrate in favor of dialogue, somewhat in line with Herzog's proposal. Among the demonstrators, a few Netanyahu relatives.

Monday, February 20

The first reading of some of the laws for the judiciary overhaul will take place in the Knesset during the night. Violent demonstrations against it outside the building and inside. Demonstrators were forcefully expelled from the Parliament's balcony.

The head of Shin Bet (the Israeli security service) warns that the country stands on the brink of a catastrophic explosion. Likud veteran Dan Meridor calls on Netanyahu to stop the legal overhaul for the sake of the country. Many Likud members wonder if the boss is still in charge.

The president of the Security Council expresses profound concern at Israeli plans to build up the nine temporary settlements (*maahazim*) authorized earlier in the month. The US does not criticize the declaration.

Those whom he wants to ruin, Jupiter maddens (*dementat*).

Tuesday, February 21

The coalition is attempting to install a political majority on the nominating committee for Supreme Court justices, so that it can control forthcoming appointments—including the replacement for Chief Justice Hayut, who is about to retire in the fall. This would ensure that the next Supreme Court would be ready to exonerate Netanyahu and, all in all, to accept a system of